

A SVM Binary Classifier for Automated Detection of Tomato Leaf Diseases in Low-cost
Greenhouse Environments

by

DARSHAN PILLAY (21766444)

submitted in accordance with the requirements
of the Honours Degree Project Module

HRCOS82 (Project 10.6)

at the

UNIVERSITY OF SOUTH AFRICA

SUPERVISOR: DR A THOMAS

2025

ASSIGNMENT NUMBER: 212149

Abstract

Plant diseases significantly reduce agricultural yield, putting the global food supply at risk. Traditional pathogen detection methods rely on plant pathology expertise. Moreover, traditional methods are destructive, labor-intensive, and time-consuming. Thus, plant phenotyping image processing tools are used as an alternative for detecting plant pathogens; however, these tools can be inflexible, commercially owned, and expensive. Consequently, there is demand for flexible, reliable, open-source image processing tools for plant pathogen detection in low-cost agricultural environments. Accordingly, a support vector machine (SVM) binary classifier was developed to detect tomato leaf diseases. This paper presents and evaluates the performance of this image processing tool. The classifier is trained using textural parameters calculated from gray-level co-occurrence matrices. These parameters are extracted from images of tomato leaves in the publicly available PlantVillage dataset. Overall, the image processing tool is shown to be reliable and efficient in detecting tomato leaf diseases. The underlying implementation is open-source and utilizes modular computer vision libraries, enabling other researchers to modify or extend it. Additionally, the classifier can be turned into a mobile application for low-cost automated greenhouse management. Overall, the developed image processing tool is flexible, reliable, modifiable, and efficient in detecting tomato plant leaf pathogens.

Contents

1	Introduction	2
2	Literature Review	4
2.1	Plant Phenotyping	4
2.1.1	What Is Plant Phenotyping?	4
2.1.2	Plant Phenotyping As Method For Improving Plant Traits	5
2.1.3	Image-Obtainable Phenotypical Traits As Indicators Of Plant Health, Growth, And Stress	5
2.2	Image-Based Plant Phenotyping	6
2.2.1	Image-Based Plant Phenotyping Versus Traditional Meth- ods	6
2.2.2	Image Acquisition Techniques	6
2.2.3	Image Processing Techniques	7
2.3	Low-cost Automated Image-Based Plant Phenotyping In Green- houses	8
2.3.1	Open-source Software, Systems and Affordable Hardware As Cost Reducers In Image-Based Plant Phenotyping	8
2.3.2	Challenges In Automated Image-Based Plant Phenotyping	8
2.3.3	Potential Advances For Low-Cost Automated Image-Based Plant Phenotyping	9
2.4	Conclusion	10
3	Materials and Methods	11
3.1	Dataset	11
3.2	Image processing pipeline	11
3.2.1	Preprocessing Phase	11
3.2.2	Segmentation Phase	12
3.2.3	Feature Extraction Phase	13
3.3	Classification Mechanism	14
3.4	Analysis	14
A	Plagiarism Pledge	15
	Bibliography	16

Introduction

Plant diseases can have devastating effects on crops, leading to reduced overall yield [1, 2]. All approaches for developing disease-resistant crops or detecting plant pathogens require measurements of observable plant traits (phenotypes) [3]. Traditional plant phenotyping methods in plant pathogen detection require expertise. Moreover, these methods are destructive, labour-intensive, and time-consuming [4]. Therefore, traditional plant phenotyping methods are not suitable for monitoring large plant population sizes over time [5, 6, 7, 8]. As an alternative, non-destructive plant phenotyping methods using image processing have been developed [9], which are efficient, affordable, and allow larger samples of plants to be examined over time. However, these image-based solutions can be costly, making them inaccessible to less affluent plant growers [10, 11, 12]. Existing low-cost image-based phenotyping systems are patented, rendering the hardware and software of these systems inflexible and unmodifiable [13]. Furthermore, many image processing tools in plant phenotyping are designed for specific plant species and environments and therefore cannot be generalized to other plant species and contexts [6, 14]. Consequently, there is a need for low-cost, flexible, modifiable, generalizable, and extendable automated image processing tools for plant phenotyping in the field of plant pathogen detection.

Recent developments in image-based plant phenotyping systems research show an increased development of plant phenotyping systems that use open-source hardware [15, 12] and software libraries [5]. Despite these advances, several challenges still remain. In low-cost settings, commonly used strategies to manage the issues of large-scale image analysis and processing of phenotypic data include low-complexity traditional segmentation methods [12], the use of more affordable and straightforward imaging sensing technologies in low-cost off-the-shelf hardware [11], and image compression techniques [16]. However, each of these strategies comes with trade-offs in terms of precision, accuracy, and phenotypic analysis capabilities. Low-complexity traditional segmentation methods struggle to handle component-based phenotyping of specific organs in plants while requiring fewer computational resources [17]. RGB sensors are affordable and generate less raw data than other methods, such as hyperspectral imaging;

however, their use is limited to the phenotyping of physiological plant traits [14]. Image compression techniques can be used to reduce the amount of data transmission required for remote analysis but have a non-negligible impact on the accuracy of image segmentation [16]. Therefore, a delicate balance must be struck between cost and numerous factors that affect the overall precision, accuracy, and measurability of phenotypic traits [18].

In response to the aforementioned challenges of image-based phenotyping solutions in plant pathogen detection, this paper aims to develop a binary support vector machine (SVM) [19] classifier for the detection of tomato plant leaf diseases. The proposed classifier is trained using the publicly available PlantVillage dataset [20], and its overall reliability and performance are measured.

The remainder of this paper is organized as follows: Section 2, the literature review, presents the fundamentals of plant phenotyping and its relation to plant pathogen detection. Particular emphasis is placed on existing image-based systems for plant pathogen detection. Thereafter, in section 3, the methodology, we discuss the proposed classification framework, detailing how images are processed, how the SVM classifier is trained, and how the overall system’s performance and reliability are evaluated. In section 4, we discuss our experimental results after our SVM classifier has been trained and evaluated. Lastly, in section 5, we discuss possible extensions of our classifier, potential future research directions, and implications of our experimental results.

Literature Review

In this section, the literature related to image-processing in tomato plant pathogen detection is reviewed. First a high-level overview of plant phenotyping is given, since plant phenotyping is foundational to image-processing methods in plant disease detection. Image-based phenotyping methods are then discussed, highlighting the advantages these methods have over traditional ones. Next, a classification of these solutions into three types is presented: traditional, machine learning, and deep learning solutions. And this classification is used to evaluate current image-processing solutions for plant pathogen detection across different crops, with emphasis on tomato plants. Finally, the main challenges and limitations of these methods are identified and possible solutions are presented.

2.1 Plant Phenotyping

Abiotic and biotic stressors limit cultivar biomass and yield [21], whilst human population growth strains the global food supply. Plant breeding, the process of inducing desirable, inheritable traits in plants through controlled human action [22], is now crucial in addressing the challenge of providing an adequate global food supply. Plant breeders require effective techniques to produce germplasm for cultivars that maximise yield and biomass under various adverse environmental conditions. In the last few decades, image processing techniques in plant phenotyping have proven to be an effective tool for plant breeding [23].

2.1.1 What Is Plant Phenotyping?

Plant phenotyping is the evaluation of phenotypes in plants [24], where phenotypes are primitive or complex traits of an organism that can be observed or quantified and evaluated numerically [25]. Phenotypes can alternatively be seen as a combination of all morphological, physiological, chemical, and behavioural aspects that represent the individual plant [26, 27, 14].

2.1.2 Plant Phenotyping As Method For Improving Plant Traits

Phenotypical traits serve as proxies in determining whether specific genotypes have favourable traits in particular environmental conditions. Quantitative data produced by plant phenotyping is most helpful in analyzing plant-environment interactions in plant breeding [24] for the development of germplasm with improved plant traits [14]. The data produced by phenotyping is used as a proxy for assessing a plant’s performance in its environment. For example, stressors or disturbances in plants are induced by environmental conditions to which organisms are exposed, and these stressors induce symptoms that can be detected and evaluated using phenotyping. Hence, phenotypical traits of a plant have a complex dynamic feedback loop with their environment [28]. Many phenotypical traits are observable or quantifiable by image processing techniques.

2.1.3 Image-Obtainable Phenotypical Traits As Indicators Of Plant Health, Growth, And Stress

2.1.3.1 Simple Taxonomy of Phenotypical Traits

A phenotypical trait is classifiable as morphological, physiological, or temporal. Additionally, the literature indicates morphological and physiological phenotypical traits are classifiable as holistic-based or component-based [29]. Holistic properties consider the plant as a whole, whereas component-based features examine individual parts of the organism, such as its fruit, flower, leaves, stem, etc.

2.1.3.2 Leaf-Derived Phenotypical Traits: Robust Proxy Indicators of Plant Metabolic and Physiological Status

Leaf-derived traits are among the most used indicators of plant status because leaves rapidly respond to environmental stimuli and robustly indicate various factors that determine plant health, growth, and stress [7]. Traits of leaves can monitor and predict a host of plant health, growth and stress factors. For example, leaf area predicts plant productivity because reduced leaf area results in decreased chlorophyll content and less photosynthesis. Therefore, leaf area is a good proxy measure for evaluating plant growth and has been used to monitor and estimate crop yield and health [30]. Various other leaf morphological traits exist in plant phenotyping. These include leaf number and inclination angle for monitoring plant growth and development [31, 7], and leaf thickness for measuring abiotic stressors like water scarcity [32]. Additionally, physiological traits of leaves exist that indicate various factors of plant status, such as stomatal conductance for detecting biotic stressors like pathogens [33] and leaf water content for drought stress [34]. Considering the above, leaf-derived phenotypical traits are robust proxies of various metabolic and physiological plant parameters.

2.1.3.3 Alternative Phenotypical Traits

Although leaves play an important role in evaluating plant growth, health and resilience to stress, these evaluations cannot be scaled to the whole plant [7]. Rather, other parts of the plant should be phenotyped to understand the processes governing plant status comprehensively. The literature is rife with such examples that study traits of roots [35], stems [36], seeds [37], and fruit [38].

2.2 Image-Based Plant Phenotyping

2.2.1 Image-Based Plant Phenotyping Versus Traditional Methods

Image-based plant phenotyping methods have several advantages over traditional methods. Traditional plant phenotyping methods are destructive, prone to human error, time-consuming, and challenging to perform from start to end of a plant’s ontogenesis [6, 7, 8]. Recent advances in image sensing, processing, and data management have produced high-throughput image-based plant phenotyping systems, which are amenable to automation and can analyse large samples of data precisely in a very short period. These image processing solutions reduce the need for potentially erroneous, time-consuming, expensive human labour in plant phenotyping [29]. Despite these advantages, several aspects of image processing, which determine the overall cost, efficiency, and applicability of image processing in plant phenotyping contexts, are important. The most important of these aspects are image acquisition and processing tasks.

These Modern high-throughput image-based plant phenotyping systems are examples of cyberinfrastructure (CI) systems [38], which are research environments that support data acquisition, storage, management and computing and processing services distributed over some network [39]. For image-based plant phenotyping, this means that image acquisition and processing techniques are vital.

2.2.2 Image Acquisition Techniques

2.2.2.1 The importance of Image Acquisition in Plant Phenotyping

Image processing techniques in plant phenotyping cannot be applied until suitable images are acquired, and the choice of imaging technique for data acquisition affects the types of phenotypical parameters that can be measured. Image sensor advancements have provided the foundations for detecting various information from plants using electromagnetic radiation. Plant tissues interact with this radiation by absorbing, reflecting, emitting, transmitting, and fluorescing light. Different ranges of wavelengths correspond to different biochemical or physiological aspects of plant tissue, which are not visible to the naked eye [14].

Therefore, the appropriate selection of image acquisition techniques is crucial for analysing different types of plant traits.

2.2.2.2 Common Image Sensor Techniques In Plant Phenotyping

Commonly used image acquisition techniques include visible, fluorescence, thermal, tomographic, and hyperspectral imaging [40, 14]. The most popular techniques are visible and hyperspectral imaging due to their affordability, robustness and flexibility in measuring a wide range of phenotypic parameters. Visible imaging is an affordable option that utilises high-resolution RGB cameras. These devices are sensitive to the visible spectral range and have been used to measure various phenotypic parameters like shoot biomass, yield and leaf morphology, and salinity tolerance [41, 42]. Hyperspectral imaging is another widely used in plant phenotyping. In this technique, sensors capture multiple spectral ranges, allowing for detailed measurements of various phenotypic parameters. Notable applications of hyperspectral imaging include estimating nutrient content and detecting plant responses to abiotic or biotic stressors [43]. The other imaging techniques are not as widely used as visible or hyperspectral imaging; however, they are also effective in measuring plant phenotypic parameters. For instance, thermal imaging in plant water stress relations [14, 33], fluorescence imaging in plant pathogenic symptom monitoring [44, 45], and tomography in estimating plant organ water content [46].

2.2.3 Image Processing Techniques

2.2.3.1 The importance of Image Segmentation in Plant Phenotyping

There is a lack of generalised or standardised image-processing techniques in plant phenotyping; hence, bespoke image-processing pipelines are designed for specific plant species or genotypes, such as Arabidopsis [14, 47]. However, segmentation is a key image-processing task common to many image-based plant phenotyping solutions. Moreover, the validity and precision of the derived phenotypical measurements and analysis depend on the image segmentation method selected [17, 18], because the accuracy of more complex tasks, such as object detection, 3D reconstruction, and classification, depends on segmentation accuracy. Therefore, image segmentation methods are integral to image processing in plant phenotyping.

2.2.3.2 Commonly Used Image Segmentation Techniques

In plant phenotyping, selecting the appropriate segmentation technique is crucial when considering the type of phenotypic parameter to be measured. Segmentation methods are typically classifiable as traditional or learning-based [17]. Traditional segmentation methods typically target holistic phenotypical traits like plant height and include frame differencing [48], colour-based [49], edge detection [50], spectral band difference-based [51], shape modelling-based

[52], and graph-based segmentation [53]. In contrast to traditional techniques, learning-based methods, which utilise machine learning or deep learning [54, 55], are more suitable for targeting component-based traits of specific organs or parts of a plant [17].

2.3 Low-cost Automated Image-Based Plant Phenotyping In Greenhouses

Many automated phenotypical image processing systems in greenhouses employ various advanced technologies, such as robotics [56], automated conveyor belts, and benchtop configurations [57, 58], as well as advanced image sensors in high-throughput phenotyping systems [59]. However, these solutions are not accessible to all plant growers because they tend to be costly [10, 11, 12]. Moreover, many systems are patented by specialized companies, rendering the hardware and software inflexible and unmodifiable [13]. Furthermore, existing low-cost phenotyping systems in greenhouses have bespoke image analysis and processing pipelines, which prevent them from being generalized and used in broader contexts [6, 14]. Therefore, there is a need for low-cost, flexible, modifiable, generalizable, and extendable automated image processing systems for plant phenotyping applications.

2.3.1 Open-source Software, Systems and Affordable Hardware As Cost Reducers In Image-Based Plant Phenotyping

Recent studies in low-cost automated image-based plant phenotyping show increased development of open-source phenotyping systems and the use of readily accessible commercial off-the-shelf hardware [15, 12] to reduce the costs of image-based phenotyping in greenhouse environments. Cheap low-cost compute sensors called Raspberry PIs have been used with affordable RGB and hyperspectral sensors to monitor phenotypic traits in greenhouse environments [11]. Additionally, there has been an increase in open-source image-processing plant phenotyping systems like Phenobox [13]. Despite these advances, several challenges remain in low-cost plant phenotyping systems.

2.3.2 Challenges In Automated Image-Based Plant Phenotyping

2.3.2.1 Large Image Sensor Data Throughput Necessitates Robust Image Processing Tools

Modern image sensors in image-based phenotyping generate massive amounts of data [60], necessitating the development of efficient image processing pipelines in these contexts to handle large datasets in the shortest possible time while also

delivering precise and accurate phenotypical analysis [12]. Therefore, effective choices in image sensors are crucial for developing low-cost, automated image-based phenotyping systems [7].

2.3.2.2 The Effects of Image Sensor Choice On Phenotypical Analysis And Processing

The choice of sensor has a non-trivial influence on the image analysis and processing techniques used in plant phenotyping and additionally also determines the breadth of traits that can be analysed [14]. For example, hyperspectral imaging is practical for studying plant metabolic status; however, the sensors required generate Terabytes of data when monitoring multiple plants [61]. Consequently, in low-cost settings, hyperspectral imaging of component-based phenotypical traits becomes infeasible because learning-based image techniques, which are most suitable for this purpose, are costly, time-consuming, and impractical when large amounts of phenotypical data are processed [61]. Additionally, low-cost hardware has constrained bandwidth, storage, and compute power. Therefore, remote cloud image processing and analysis are required [62], which can be expensive [12].

2.3.2.3 Solutions, and Limitations For Low-cost Large Data Throughput Image Processing Systems

In low-cost settings, commonly used strategies to manage the issues of large-scale image analysis and processing of phenotypic data include low-complexity traditional segmentation methods [12], the use of more affordable and straightforward imaging sensing technologies in low-cost off-the-shelf hardware [11], and image compression techniques [16]. However, each of these strategies comes with trade-offs in terms of precision, accuracy, and phenotypic analysis capabilities. Low-complexity traditional segmentation methods struggle to handle component-based phenotyping of specific organs in plants while requiring fewer computational resources [17]. RGB sensors are affordable and generate less raw data than other methods, such as hyperspectral imaging; however, their use is limited to the phenotyping of physiological plant traits [14]. Image compression techniques can be used to reduce the amount of data transmission required for remote analysis but have a non-negligible impact on the accuracy of image segmentation [16]. Therefore, a delicate balance must be struck between cost and numerous factors that affect the overall precision, accuracy, and measurability of phenotypic traits [18].

2.3.3 Potential Advances For Low-Cost Automated Image-Based Plant Phenotyping

Numerous opportunities exist to improve the overall affordability and generalisability of plant phenotyping in automated greenhouse environments. Low-cost plant phenotyping is not a nascent field of inquiry. However, many tracts of

innovation have not been fully exploited. For instance, learning-based imaging techniques for analysis and processing can reduce analysis and segmentation costs but struggle when executed on resource-constrained hardware [39]. Therefore, there is a need for the development of efficient and optimised deep-learning or machine-learning models in resource-constrained environments. Similarly, many existing phenotyping systems are not generalizable to other plant species [14, 47] and rely on proprietary software or hardware [13]. Hence, there are opportunities to develop modifiable and flexible image-processing pipelines that are amenable to a broader variety of plant phenotyping contexts. Additionally, there are not many mobile applications for plant phenotyping. Mobile devices have advanced image sensors and can locally run image analysis and processing tasks, eliminating the need for cloud computing resources that increase phenotyping costs [18].

2.4 Conclusion

Ensuring an adequate food supply in response to the growing human population is crucial [63]. Image-based plant phenotyping has proven to be an effective tool for this purpose, aiding in the development of cultivars with maximum yield and resistance to various environmental stressors [23]. These methods are non-destructive, more time-efficient, replicable, and affordable than traditional methods [29]. However, image sensors in plant phenotyping generate large amounts of data, which necessitate robust image analysis and processing tools to handle this data effectively [60]. Large plant data throughput makes image-based plant phenotyping in automated greenhouse environments cost-prohibitive, as affordable off-the-shelf hardware and sensors often lack adequate local resources to store or process large amounts of data [61]. Consequently, remote cloud computing solutions handle image processing and analysis tasks [62], which can further increase operational costs in greenhouse management [12]. Image-data compression techniques, low-complexity image analysis and processing techniques, and low-cost off-the-shelf hardware are effective in reducing the cost of image-based plant phenotyping by reducing the computational requirements and data throughput [16, 11, 12]. However, these solutions come with marked trade-offs in terms of accuracy, precision, depth, and breadth of plant trait analysis. Moreover, existing solutions are not generalizable to other environments and plant species [6, 14]. In short, there is a need for low-cost, open-source, flexible, modifiable, and robust plant phenotyping image processing and analysis tools that are effective and efficient on resource-constrained hardware [12]. Future research should develop low-cost image processing tools that are precise, accurate, and adaptable to various plant monitoring contexts or parameters. In doing so, automated image-based techniques for plant monitoring will become more accessible in low-cost greenhouse environments.

Materials and Methods

3.1 Dataset

The PlantVillage dataset is used in our study. PlantVillage is a collection of 54309 annotated diseased and healthy leaf images spanning several plant species, including tomato [20]. The size of the subset of tomato leaf images is 18162. Several images of each tomato leaf were captured outside under natural light in various lighting conditions and orientations, against a black or grey background, using a standard digital camera [20, 1]. The images are captured in the RGB colour space and have dimensions 256x256. We have selected PlantVillage as our primary dataset because it is widely used in image processing research for plant disease detection [64, 65, 66, 67, 68, 69]. Using this dataset will allow future researchers to compare our proposed method to previous studies.

3.2 Image processing pipeline

Many studies in image-based plant disease detection typically have predetermined phases in their image processing pipeline. Namely, preprocessing, segmentation, and feature extraction [66, 70, 71, 72, 73]. We follow suit and include each of those phases in our image processing pipeline.

3.2.1 Preprocessing Phase

Preprocessing involves tasks such as noise removal, image enhancement, and colour space conversion. In image acquisition, noise from the imaging sensor, the environment, or another source can compromise the accuracy of downstream image processing and classification phases. For example, we choose a global thresholding segmentation method, which we discuss later, and these methods often perform poorly in the presence of noise or uneven illumination [74]. Nevertheless, preprocessing steps such as histogram equalisation and median filtering effectively mitigate noise and illumination issues [74, 75, 76]. Thus, preprocessing is a crucial phase of image processing pipelines, which enhances the overall accuracy of segmentation and image classification [1, 77]. Therefore, we apply

several preprocessing steps to enhance the overall effectiveness and accuracy of our segmentation and classification phases.

We aim to compute texture features of the tomato leaf in each image using the grey-level co-occurrence matrix [78], which requires a grey-level image to calculate. Therefore, the first preprocessing step we perform is the conversion from the leaf image’s original RGB colour space to the grayscale colour space.

Once we obtain the grayscale image of the tomato leaf, we apply histogram equalisation. This preprocessing method is used in the literature to add more contrast between the background and foreground of an image [75]. Image contrast enhancement is achieved by uniformly distributing the grey-level intensity values of the image [74], which makes histogram equalisation particularly useful for dealing with various illumination conditions [1].

Lastly, we apply median filtering to remove common salt-and-pepper noise from the image. Median filtering is an effective image enhancement preprocessing step that has been successfully used in plant leaf disease detection [49, 73]. Noise manifests as sharp transitions in image intensity seen in the grayscale image histogram [74], therefore noise can negatively affect the accuracy of global threshold segmentation methods, which we use in this study; therefore, to enhance segmentation accuracy and robustness, we apply median filtering to denoise the image.

3.2.2 Segmentation Phase

We use the Otsu method [79] for segmentation. The global thresholding Otsu method is used for segmentation. Global thresholding methods partition images into regions based on their intensity values using the image’s grey-level histogram. For simple background removal, we select a suitable threshold T . If the intensity of the image at a point (x, y) exceeds T , then that part of the image is considered part of the foreground; otherwise, it is considered part of the background. If applied as a spatial-intensity transform, a binary mask is obtained where the intensity value of the foreground is set to 1, and the background is set to 0. Global thresholding performs poorly when there is low contrast between the background and foreground, large amounts of noise, and when the background intensity varies significantly across the image [80]. More accurate segmentation can be achieved using adaptive thresholding [81]. Another option is learning-based segmentation, but it requires substantial amounts of training data to achieve reliable segmentation [82]. However, global thresholding is a simple, easy to implement, computationally efficient [74, 81]. For this reason, we make the trade-off of poorer segmentation accuracy and robustness for computational efficiency. Moreover, global thresholding methods are applied in many studies in the literature for image-based plant phenotyping applications [64].

The Otsu method automatically selects a threshold value that maximises the interclass variance of the intensity levels between the background and foreground in the image’s grey-level histogram. This method is widely used in the literature [64, 83], and can be utilised for background removal in plant image processing pipelines [71]. However, the Otsu method is sensitive to noise and lacks robustness to uneven illumination [64]. Despite the method’s shortcomings, we have selected it because Otsu segmentation yields good segmentation results, is easy to implement, and is highly efficient [83, 64].

Concretely, for each leaf image, our segmentation phase aims to segment the leaf from its background. During feature extraction, we wish to obtain textural features of the leaf using information represented in the leaf’s grayscale image. Therefore, background removal is crucial in ensuring that feature extraction considers the textural information of the leaf, rather than the background. The aforementioned Otsu segmentation method is applied to the grayscale leaf image obtained from the preprocessing phase. The result of the segmentation is a binary mask, and background removal is achieved by applying the binary mask to the preprocessed grayscale leaf image.

3.2.3 Feature Extraction Phase

After segmentation, we have the isolated leaf image in the grey-scale colour space, and proceed to feature extraction. We are only extracting textural features from metrics calculated using a grey-level co-occurrence matrix [78]. Textural features are empirically some of the best predictors of leaf disease detection [84, 85], since the occurrence of a plant disease induces specific changes in the texture of the leaf [86]. Thus, we choose textural features because we can construct feature vectors from these texture metrics to train a classifier to detect the presence or absence of a tomato leaf disease [87, 86, 85].

Gray-level co-occurrence matrices (GLCM) [78] measure the statistical spatial distribution of gray-level tones, and several parameters can be calculated from these matrices to investigate the textural properties of an object in an image [88]. GLCM derived textural features are widely used in the literature to detect plant leaf diseases [85, 86].

Following the approach in [86], we compute a GLCM from the grayscale leaf image produced by the segmentation phase. Thereafter, we extract the following parameters from the GLCM: energy, contrast, sum of squares, correlation, entropy, sum entropy, cluster shade, cluster prominence, and homogeneity metrics [85, 78, 86]. Together, all these calculated GLCM parameters form a feature vector, which we will use in our classification mechanism, as discussed in the next section.

3.3 Classification Mechanism

For our classification mechanism, we use a support vector machine (SVM) [19] to determine if a tomato leaf is diseased or healthy. SVM is a supervised machine learning method that has been shown to be an effective classifier of leaf diseases [86, 1, 89, 69]. SVM classifies several different classes by finding an optimal hyperplane that linearly separates them. SVMs can learn non-simple datasets and generalize well [1].

To obtain the training dataset, we apply our aforementioned image processing steps to obtain texture feature vectors. The feature vector is labeled as healthy if it is generated from a healthy PlantVillage tomato leaf image; otherwise, it is labeled as diseased.

With this training dataset, we train our Support Vector Machine using the radial basis function kernel [90]. To avoid overfitting and bias from the dataset, we perform 10-fold cross-validation [91]. In this training methodology, the data set is divided equally or nearly equally into 10 subsets. Then, cross-validation is performed 10 times, where one set is selected as the test set, and the union of the others forms the training set. The cross-validation procedure is repeated 10 times.

3.4 Analysis

We aim to measure the reliability of our binary SVM tomato classifier by evaluating its F-measure, accuracy, precision, actual positive rate, and true negative rate [91]. These metrics are commonly used to measure the performance of binary classifiers and predictive models [92]; therefore, their use allows comparison of our system with other studies. Additionally, we measure the average classification time of the system, which is the time it takes for classification to occur from the start of preprocessing to the end of classification.

Plagiarism Pledge

Plagiarism Pledge

1. I have read Unisa's plagiarism policy.
2. I understand Unisa's plagiarism policy.
3. I agree to abide by Unisa's plagiarism policy.
4. All academic work, written or otherwise, that I submit is expected to be the result of my own skill and labour.
5. I understand that, if I am guilty of the infringement of breach of copyright/plagiarism or unethical practice, I will be subject to the applicable disciplinary code as determined by Unisa.
6. I understand that my supervisor will use Turnitin (or similar plagiarism tool) to check submitted research for plagiarism.
7. The supervisor has the right to return any work to be revised if plagiarism is detected.

Student name: Darshan Pillay

Student number: 21766444

Student signature: 

Date: 26 May 2025

Bibliography

- [1] S. M. Kiran and D. N. Chandrappa. “Plant Leaf Disease Detection Using Efficient Image Processing and Machine Learning Algorithms”. In: *Journal of Robotics and Control (JRC)* 4.6 (6 Nov. 30, 2023), pp. 840–848. ISSN: 2715-5072. DOI: [10.18196/jrc.v4i6.20342](https://doi.org/10.18196/jrc.v4i6.20342). URL: <https://journal.umy.ac.id/index.php/jrc/article/view/20342> (visited on 07/27/2025).
- [2] Vijay Kumar Trivedi, Piyush Kumar Shukla, and Anjana Pandey. “Automatic Segmentation of Plant Leaves Disease Using Min-Max Hue Histogram and k-Mean Clustering”. In: *Multimedia Tools and Applications* 81.14 (June 1, 2022), pp. 20201–20228. ISSN: 1573-7721. DOI: [10.1007/s11042-022-12518-7](https://doi.org/10.1007/s11042-022-12518-7). URL: <https://doi.org/10.1007/s11042-022-12518-7> (visited on 07/29/2025).
- [3] Malia A. Gehan et al. “PlantCV v2: Image Analysis Software for High-Throughput Plant Phenotyping”. In: *PeerJ* 5 (Dec. 1, 2017), e4088. ISSN: 2167-8359. DOI: [10.7717/peerj.4088](https://doi.org/10.7717/peerj.4088). PMID: 29209576. URL: <https://www.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/pmc/articles/PMC5713628/> (visited on 07/25/2025).
- [4] Ibrar Hussain and Rifaqat Ali. “Robust Leaf Disease Detection Using Complex Fuzzy Sets and HSV-Based Color Segmentation Techniques”. In: (Sept. 29, 2024). DOI: [10.56578/ataiml030305](https://doi.org/10.56578/ataiml030305). URL: https://www.acadlore.com/article/ATAIML/2024_3_3/ataiml030305 (visited on 07/26/2025).
- [5] Noah Fahlgren et al. “A Versatile Phenotyping System and Analytics Platform Reveals Diverse Temporal Responses to Water Availability in Setaria”. In: *Molecular Plant* 8.10 (Oct. 5, 2015), pp. 1520–1535. ISSN: 1674-2052. DOI: [10.1016/j.molp.2015.06.005](https://doi.org/10.1016/j.molp.2015.06.005). URL: <https://www.sciencedirect.com/science/article/pii/S1674205215002683> (visited on 07/25/2025).
- [6] Jayme Garcia Arnal Barbedo. “Digital Image Processing Techniques for Detecting, Quantifying and Classifying Plant Diseases”. In: *SpringerPlus* 2.1 (Dec. 7, 2013), pp. 1–12. ISSN: 2193-1801. DOI: [10.1186/2193-1801-2-660](https://doi.org/10.1186/2193-1801-2-660). URL: <https://doi.org/10.1186/2193-1801-2-660> (visited on 05/11/2025).

- [7] Huichun Zhang et al. “High-Throughput Phenotyping of Plant Leaf Morphological, Physiological, and Biochemical Traits on Multiple Scales Using Optical Sensing”. In: *The Crop Journal* 11.5 (Oct. 1, 2023), pp. 1303–1318. ISSN: 2214-5141. DOI: [10.1016/j.cj.2023.04.014](https://doi.org/10.1016/j.cj.2023.04.014). URL: <https://www.sciencedirect.com/science/article/pii/S2214514123000740> (visited on 05/20/2025).
- [8] R. H. Laxman et al. “Non-Invasive Quantification of Tomato (*Solanum Lycopersicum* L.) Plant Biomass through Digital Imaging Using Phenomics Platform”. In: *Indian Journal of Plant Physiology* 23.2 (June 1, 2018), pp. 369–375. ISSN: 0974-0252. DOI: [10.1007/s40502-018-0374-8](https://doi.org/10.1007/s40502-018-0374-8). URL: <https://doi.org/10.1007/s40502-018-0374-8> (visited on 05/24/2025).
- [9] Robert T. Furbank and Mark Tester. “Phenomics – Technologies to Relieve the Phenotyping Bottleneck”. In: *Trends in Plant Science* 16.12 (Dec. 1, 2011), pp. 635–644. ISSN: 1360-1385. DOI: [10.1016/j.tplants.2011.09.005](https://doi.org/10.1016/j.tplants.2011.09.005). PMID: 22074787. URL: [https://www.cell.com/trends/plant-science/abstract/S1360-1385\(11\)00209-3](https://www.cell.com/trends/plant-science/abstract/S1360-1385(11)00209-3) (visited on 07/29/2025).
- [10] Max R. Lien et al. “A Low-Cost and Open-Source Platform for Automated Imaging”. In: *Plant Methods* 15.1 (Dec. 2019), pp. 2–13. ISSN: 1746-4811. DOI: [10.1186/s13007-019-0392-1](https://doi.org/10.1186/s13007-019-0392-1). URL: <https://plantmethods.biomedcentral.com/articles/10.1186/s13007-019-0392-1> (visited on 05/24/2025).
- [11] Jose C. Tovar et al. “Raspberry Pi-Powered Imaging for Plant Phenotyping”. In: *Applications in Plant Sciences* 6.3 (2018), pp. 1–2. ISSN: 2168-0450. DOI: [10.1002/aps3.1031](https://doi.org/10.1002/aps3.1031). URL: <https://onlinelibrary.wiley.com/doi/abs/10.1002/aps3.1031> (visited on 05/24/2025).
- [12] Massimo Minervini, Hanno Scharr, and Sotirios A. Tsiftaris. “Image Analysis: The New Bottleneck in Plant Phenotyping”. In: *IEEE Signal Processing Magazine* 32.4 (July 2015), pp. 126–131. ISSN: 1053-5888, 1558-0792. DOI: [10.1109/MSP.2015.2405111](https://doi.org/10.1109/MSP.2015.2405111). URL: <https://ieeexplore.ieee.org/document/7123050/> (visited on 05/24/2025).
- [13] Angelika Czedik-Eysenberg et al. “The ‘PhenoBox’, a Flexible, Automated, Open-Source Plant Phenotyping Solution”. In: *New Phytologist* 219.2 (2018), pp. 808–823. ISSN: 1469-8137. DOI: [10.1111/nph.15129](https://doi.org/10.1111/nph.15129). URL: <https://onlinelibrary.wiley.com/doi/abs/10.1111/nph.15129> (visited on 05/26/2025).
- [14] Lei Li, Qin Zhang, and Danfeng Huang. “A Review of Imaging Techniques for Plant Phenotyping”. In: *Sensors (Basel, Switzerland)* 14.11 (Oct. 24, 2014), pp. 20078–20111. ISSN: 1424-8220. DOI: [10.3390/s141120078](https://doi.org/10.3390/s141120078). PMID: 25347588. URL: <https://www.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/pmc/articles/PMC4279472/> (visited on 04/20/2025).

- [15] Dawei Li et al. “Digitization and Visualization of Greenhouse Tomato Plants in Indoor Environments”. In: *Sensors* 15.2 (2 Feb. 2015), pp. 4019–4051. ISSN: 1424-8220. DOI: [10.3390/s150204019](https://doi.org/10.3390/s150204019). URL: <https://www.mdpi.com/1424-8220/15/2/4019> (visited on 05/24/2025).
- [16] Massimo Minervini and Sotirios A. Tsaftaris. “Application-Aware Image Compression for Low Cost and Distributed Plant Phenotyping”. In: 2013 18th International Conference on Digital Signal Processing (DSP). July 2013, pp. 1–6. DOI: [10.1109/ICDSP.2013.6622670](https://doi.org/10.1109/ICDSP.2013.6622670). URL: <https://ieeexplore.ieee.org/abstract/document/6622670> (visited on 05/31/2025).
- [17] Sruti Das Choudhury. “Segmentation Techniques and Challenges in Plant Phenotyping”. In: *Intelligent Image Analysis for Plant Phenotyping*. 1st ed. CRC Press, 2020, pp. 69–91. ISBN: 978-1-315-17730-4.
- [18] Mark Müller-Linow et al. “Plant Screen Mobile: An Open-Source Mobile Device App for Plant Trait Analysis”. In: *Plant Methods* 15.1 (Dec. 2019), pp. 1–11. ISSN: 1746-4811. DOI: [10.1186/s13007-019-0386-z](https://doi.org/10.1186/s13007-019-0386-z). URL: <https://plantmethods.biomedcentral.com/articles/10.1186/s13007-019-0386-z> (visited on 05/25/2025).
- [19] Vladimir N. Vapnik. *The Nature of Statistical Learning Theory*. New York, NY: Springer New York, 2000. ISBN: 978-1-4419-3160-3 978-1-4757-3264-1. DOI: [10.1007/978-1-4757-3264-1](https://doi.org/10.1007/978-1-4757-3264-1). URL: <http://link.springer.com/10.1007/978-1-4757-3264-1> (visited on 07/28/2025).
- [20] David P. Hughes and Marcel Salathe. *An Open Access Repository of Images on Plant Health to Enable the Development of Mobile Disease Diagnostics*. Apr. 12, 2016. DOI: [10.48550/arXiv.1511.08060](https://doi.org/10.48550/arXiv.1511.08060). arXiv: [1511.08060 \[cs\]](https://arxiv.org/abs/1511.08060). URL: <http://arxiv.org/abs/1511.08060> (visited on 05/11/2025). Pre-published.
- [21] J.P. Grime. “Evidence for the Existence of Three Primary Strategies in Plants and Its Relevance to Ecological and Evolutionary Theory”. In: *The American Naturalist* 111.982 (1997), p. 1169. DOI: [10.1086/283244](https://doi.org/10.1086/283244). URL: <https://www.journals.uchicago.edu/doi/abs/10.1086/283244> (visited on 05/19/2025).
- [22] Thomas J. Orton. “Introduction”. In: *Horticultural Plant Breeding*. Elsevier, 2020, pp. 3–7. ISBN: 978-0-12-815396-3. DOI: [10.1016/B978-0-12-815396-3.09986-8](https://doi.org/10.1016/B978-0-12-815396-3.09986-8). URL: <https://linkinghub.elsevier.com/retrieve/pii/B9780128153963099868> (visited on 05/16/2025).
- [23] Achala Anand, Madhumitha Subramanian, and Debasish Kar. “Breeding Techniques to Dispense Higher Genetic Gains”. In: *Frontiers in Plant Science* 13 (Jan. 19, 2023), pp. 1–5. ISSN: 1664-462X. DOI: [10.3389/fpls.2022.1076094](https://doi.org/10.3389/fpls.2022.1076094). URL: <https://www.frontiersin.org/journals/plant-science/articles/10.3389/fpls.2022.1076094/full> (visited on 05/16/2025).

- [24] Fabio Fiorani and Ulrich Schurr. “Future Scenarios for Plant Phenotyping”. In: *Annual Review of Plant Biology* 64.1 (Apr. 29, 2013), pp. 267–291. ISSN: 1543-5008, 1545-2123. DOI: [10.1146/annurev-arplant-050312-120137](https://doi.org/10.1146/annurev-arplant-050312-120137). URL: <https://www.annualreviews.org/doi/10.1146/annurev-arplant-050312-120137> (visited on 05/14/2025).
- [25] W. Johannsen. “The Genotype Conception of Heredity”. In: *The American Naturalist* 45.531 (Mar. 1911), pp. 129–159. ISSN: 0003-0147, 1537-5323. DOI: [10.1086/279202](https://doi.org/10.1086/279202). URL: <https://www.journals.uchicago.edu/doi/10.1086/279202> (visited on 05/14/2025).
- [26] Qiaosheng Guo and Zaibiao Zhu. “Phenotyping of Plants”. In: *Encyclopedia of Analytical Chemistry*. John Wiley & Sons, Ltd, 2014, pp. 1–15. ISBN: 978-0-470-02731-8. DOI: [10.1002/9780470027318.a9934](https://doi.org/10.1002/9780470027318.a9934). URL: <https://onlinelibrary.wiley.com/doi/abs/10.1002/9780470027318.a9934> (visited on 05/14/2025).
- [27] Semira Ebrahim Mohammed. “Review on Plant Phenotyping”. In: *Agriculture and Biological Research* 1.41 (2025), pp. 1222–1225. URL: <https://www.abrinternationaljournal.org/abstract/review-on-plant-phenotyping-1102322.html> (visited on 05/05/2025).
- [28] Achim Walter, Frank Liebisch, and Andreas Hund. “Plant Phenotyping: From Bean Weighing to Image Analysis”. In: *Plant Methods* 11.1 (Mar. 4, 2015), pp. 1–8. ISSN: 1746-4811. DOI: [10.1186/s13007-015-0056-8](https://doi.org/10.1186/s13007-015-0056-8). URL: <https://doi.org/10.1186/s13007-015-0056-8> (visited on 05/05/2025).
- [29] Sruti Das Choudhury, Ashok Samal, and Tala Awada. “Leveraging Image Analysis for High-Throughput Plant Phenotyping”. In: *Frontiers in Plant Science* 10 (Apr. 24, 2019), pp. 1–2. ISSN: 1664-462X. DOI: [10.3389/fpls.2019.00508](https://doi.org/10.3389/fpls.2019.00508). URL: <https://www.frontiersin.org/journals/plant-science/articles/10.3389/fpls.2019.00508/full> (visited on 05/21/2025).
- [30] Juanjuan Zhang et al. “Leaf Area Index Estimation Model for UAV Image Hyperspectral Data Based on Wavelength Variable Selection and Machine Learning Methods”. In: *Plant Methods* 17.1 (May 3, 2021), pp. 1–2. ISSN: 1746-4811. DOI: [10.1186/s13007-021-00750-5](https://doi.org/10.1186/s13007-021-00750-5). URL: <https://doi.org/10.1186/s13007-021-00750-5> (visited on 05/25/2025).
- [31] J. Praveen Kumar and S. Domnic. “Rosette Plant Segmentation with Leaf Count Using Orthogonal Transform and Deep Convolutional Neural Network”. In: *Machine Vision and Applications* 31.1–2 (Feb. 2020), pp. 1–2. ISSN: 0932-8092, 1432-1769. DOI: [10.1007/s00138-019-01056-2](https://doi.org/10.1007/s00138-019-01056-2). URL: <http://link.springer.com/10.1007/s00138-019-01056-2> (visited on 05/25/2025).

- [32] Amin Afzal, Sjoerd W. Duiker, and John E. Watson. “Leaf Thickness to Predict Plant Water Status”. In: *Biosystems Engineering* 156 (Apr. 1, 2017), pp. 63–70. ISSN: 1537-5110. DOI: [10.1016/j.biosystemseng.2017.01.011](https://doi.org/10.1016/j.biosystemseng.2017.01.011). URL: <http://www.scopus.com/inward/record.url?scp=85013072400&partnerID=8YFLogxK> (visited on 05/25/2025).
- [33] Roselyne Ishimwe, K. Abutaleb, and F. Ahmed. “Applications of Thermal Imaging in Agriculture—A Review”. In: *Advances in Remote Sensing* 03.03 (2014), pp. 128–140. ISSN: 2169-267X, 2169-2688. DOI: [10.4236/ars.2014.33011](https://doi.org/10.4236/ars.2014.33011). URL: <http://www.scirp.org/journal/doi.aspx?DOI=10.4236/ars.2014.33011> (visited on 05/19/2025).
- [34] Kenta Watanabe et al. “Fundamental Study on Water Stress Detection in Sugarcane Using Thermal Image Combined with Photosynthesis Measurement Under a Greenhouse Condition”. In: *Sugar Tech* 24.5 (Oct. 1, 2022), pp. 1382–1390. ISSN: 0974-0740. DOI: [10.1007/s12355-021-01087-y](https://doi.org/10.1007/s12355-021-01087-y). URL: <https://doi.org/10.1007/s12355-021-01087-y> (visited on 05/25/2025).
- [35] Gernot Bodner et al. “Hyperspectral Imaging: A Novel Approach for Plant Root Phenotyping”. In: *Plant Methods* 14.1 (Oct. 3, 2018), pp. 1–2. ISSN: 1746-4811. DOI: [10.1186/s13007-018-0352-1](https://doi.org/10.1186/s13007-018-0352-1). URL: <https://doi.org/10.1186/s13007-018-0352-1> (visited on 05/25/2025).
- [36] Sruti Das Choudhury et al. “Automated Stem Angle Determination for Temporal Plant Phenotyping Analysis”. In: *Proceedings of the IEEE International Conference on Computer Vision Workshops*. 2017, pp. 2022–2029. DOI: [10.1109/ICCVW.2017.237](https://doi.org/10.1109/ICCVW.2017.237). URL: https://openaccess.thecvf.com/content_ICCV_2017_workshops/w29/html/Choudhury_Automated_Stem_Angle_ICCV_2017_paper.html (visited on 05/25/2025).
- [37] Chongyuan Zhang et al. “High-Throughput Phenotyping of Seed/Seedling Evaluation Using Digital Image Analysis”. In: *Agronomy* 8.5 (5 May 2018), pp. 1–2. ISSN: 2073-4395. DOI: [10.3390/agronomy8050063](https://doi.org/10.3390/agronomy8050063). URL: <https://www.mdpi.com/2073-4395/8/5/63> (visited on 05/25/2025).
- [38] Alebel Mekuriaw Abebe et al. “Image-Based High-Throughput Phenotyping in Horticultural Crops”. In: *Plants* 12.10 (10 Jan. 2023), pp. 1–16. ISSN: 2223-7747. DOI: [10.3390/plants12102061](https://doi.org/10.3390/plants12102061). URL: <https://www.mdpi.com/2223-7747/12/10/2061> (visited on 05/25/2025).
- [39] Shona Nabwire et al. “Review: Application of Artificial Intelligence in Phenomics”. In: *Sensors* 21.13 (June 25, 2021), pp. 1–18. ISSN: 1424-8220. DOI: [10.3390/s21134363](https://doi.org/10.3390/s21134363). URL: <https://www.mdpi.com/1424-8220/21/13/4363> (visited on 05/25/2025).
- [40] Ruicheng Qiu et al. “Sensors for Measuring Plant Phenotyping: A Review”. In: *International Journal of Agriculture and Biological Engineering* 11.2 (2018), pp. 1–14. DOI: <https://dx.doi.org/10.25165/j.ijabe.20181102.2696>. URL: <http://www.ijabe.net/cn/article/doi/10.25165/j.ijabe.20181102.2696> (visited on 05/09/2025).

- [41] Mahmood R Golzarian et al. “Accurate Inference of Shoot Biomass from High-Throughput Images of Cereal Plants”. In: *Plant Methods* 7.1 (Dec. 2011), pp. 1–2. ISSN: 1746-4811. DOI: [10.1186/1746-4811-7-2](https://doi.org/10.1186/1746-4811-7-2). URL: <https://plantmethods.biomedcentral.com/articles/10.1186/1746-4811-7-2> (visited on 05/26/2025).
- [42] V. Hoyos-Villegas et al. “Ground-Based Digital Imaging as a Tool to Assess Soybean Growth and Yield”. In: *Crop Science* 54.4 (2014), pp. 1756–1768. ISSN: 1435-0653. DOI: [10.2135/cropsci2013.08.0540](https://doi.org/10.2135/cropsci2013.08.0540). URL: <https://onlinelibrary.wiley.com/doi/abs/10.2135/cropsci2013.08.0540> (visited on 05/26/2025).
- [43] Rijad Sarić et al. “Applications of Hyperspectral Imaging in Plant Phenotyping”. In: *Trends in Plant Science* 27.3 (Mar. 1, 2022), pp. 301–315. ISSN: 1360-1385. DOI: [10.1016/j.tplants.2021.12.003](https://doi.org/10.1016/j.tplants.2021.12.003). URL: <https://www.sciencedirect.com/science/article/pii/S1360138521003460> (visited on 05/22/2025).
- [44] Hartmut K. Lichtenthaler and Ursula Rinderle. “The Role of Chlorophyll Fluorescence in The Detection of Stress Conditions in Plants”. In: *C R C Critical Reviews in Analytical Chemistry* 19 (Supplement 1 Jan. 1, 1988), pp. 30–79. ISSN: 0007-8980. DOI: [10.1080/15476510.1988.10401466](https://doi.org/10.1080/15476510.1988.10401466). URL: <https://doi.org/10.1080/15476510.1988.10401466> (visited on 05/22/2025).
- [45] Philip J. Swarbrick, Paul Schulze-Lefert, and Julie D. Scholes. “Metabolic Consequences of Susceptibility and Resistance (Race-Specific and Broad-Spectrum) in Barley Leaves Challenged with Powdery Mildew”. In: *Plant, Cell & Environment* 29.6 (2006), pp. 1061–1076. ISSN: 1365-3040. DOI: [10.1111/j.1365-3040.2005.01472.x](https://doi.org/10.1111/j.1365-3040.2005.01472.x). URL: <https://onlinelibrary.wiley.com/doi/abs/10.1111/j.1365-3040.2005.01472.x> (visited on 05/26/2025).
- [46] Carel W. Windt et al. “MRI of Long-Distance Water Transport: A Comparison of the Phloem and Xylem Flow Characteristics and Dynamics in Poplar, Castor Bean, Tomato and Tobacco”. In: *Plant, Cell & Environment* 29.9 (2006), pp. 1715–1729. ISSN: 1365-3040. DOI: [10.1111/j.1365-3040.2006.01544.x](https://doi.org/10.1111/j.1365-3040.2006.01544.x). URL: <https://onlinelibrary.wiley.com/doi/abs/10.1111/j.1365-3040.2006.01544.x> (visited on 05/26/2025).
- [47] Samuel Arvidsson, Paulino Pérez-Rodríguez, and Bernd Mueller-Roeber. “A Growth Phenotyping Pipeline for Arabidopsis Thaliana Integrating Image Analysis and Rosette Area Modeling for Robust Quantification of Genotype Effects”. In: *New Phytologist* 191.3 (2011), pp. 895–907. ISSN: 1469-8137. DOI: [10.1111/j.1469-8137.2011.03756.x](https://doi.org/10.1111/j.1469-8137.2011.03756.x). URL: <https://onlinelibrary.wiley.com/doi/abs/10.1111/j.1469-8137.2011.03756.x> (visited on 05/26/2025).

- [48] Sruti Das Choudhury et al. “Holistic and Component Plant Phenotyping Using Temporal Image Sequence”. In: *Plant Methods* 14.1 (May 10, 2018), pp. 1–4. ISSN: 1746-4811. DOI: [10.1186/s13007-018-0303-x](https://doi.org/10.1186/s13007-018-0303-x). URL: <https://doi.org/10.1186/s13007-018-0303-x> (visited on 05/26/2025).
- [49] Esmael Hamuda, Martin Glavin, and Edward Jones. “A Survey of Image Processing Techniques for Plant Extraction and Segmentation in the Field”. In: *Computers and Electronics in Agriculture* 125 (July 2016), pp. 184–199. ISSN: 01681699. DOI: [10.1016/j.compag.2016.04.024](https://linkinghub.elsevier.com/retrieve/pii/S0168169916301557). URL: <https://linkinghub.elsevier.com/retrieve/pii/S0168169916301557> (visited on 05/26/2025).
- [50] Zhibin Wang et al. “Image Segmentation of Overlapping Leaves Based on Chan–Vese Model and Sobel Operator”. In: *Information Processing in Agriculture* 5.1 (Mar. 1, 2018), pp. 1–10. ISSN: 2214-3173. DOI: [10.1016/j.inpa.2017.09.005](https://www.sciencedirect.com/science/article/pii/S2214317317301270). URL: <https://www.sciencedirect.com/science/article/pii/S2214317317301270> (visited on 05/26/2025).
- [51] Suraj Gampa. “A Data-driven Approach for Detecting Stress in Plants Using Hyperspectral Imagery”. University of Nebraska-Lincoln, 2019.
- [52] Yuhao Chen et al. “Leaf Segmentation by Functional Modeling”. In: *2019 IEEE/CVF Conference on Computer Vision and Pattern Recognition Workshops (CVPRW)*. 2019 IEEE/CVF Conference on Computer Vision and Pattern Recognition Workshops (CVPRW). Long Beach, CA, USA: IEEE, June 2019, pp. 1–10. ISBN: 978-1-7281-2506-0. DOI: [10.1109/CVPRW.2019.00326](https://ieeexplore.ieee.org/document/9025489/). URL: <https://ieeexplore.ieee.org/document/9025489/> (visited on 05/26/2025).
- [53] J. Praveen Kumar and S. Domnic. “Image Based Leaf Segmentation and Counting in Rosette Plants”. In: *Information Processing in Agriculture* 6.2 (June 2019), pp. 233–246. ISSN: 22143173. DOI: [10.1016/j.inpa.2018.09.005](https://linkinghub.elsevier.com/retrieve/pii/S2214317318301562). URL: <https://linkinghub.elsevier.com/retrieve/pii/S2214317318301562> (visited on 05/26/2025).
- [54] Jean-Michel Pape and Christian Klukas. “Utilizing Machine Learning Approaches to Improve the Prediction of Leaf Counts and Individual Leaf Segmentation of Rosette Plant Images”. In: *Proceedings of the Proceedings of the Computer Vision Problems in Plant Phenotyping Workshop 2015*. Proceedings of the Computer Vision Problems in Plant Phenotyping Workshop 2015. Swansea: British Machine Vision Association, 2015, pp. 1–2. ISBN: 978-1-901725-55-1. DOI: [10.5244/C.29.CVPPP.3](http://www.bmva.org/bmvc/2015/cvppp/papers/paper003/index.html). URL: <http://www.bmva.org/bmvc/2015/cvppp/papers/paper003/index.html> (visited on 05/26/2025).
- [55] Alwaseela Abdalla et al. “Fine-Tuning Convolutional Neural Network with Transfer Learning for Semantic Segmentation of Ground-Level Oilseed Rape Images in a Field with High Weed Pressure”. In: *Computers and Electronics in Agriculture* 167 (Dec. 2019), pp. 1–2. ISSN: 01681699. DOI:

- 10.1016/j.compag.2019.105091. URL: <https://linkinghub.elsevier.com/retrieve/pii/S0168169919317107> (visited on 05/26/2025).
- [56] Amine Saddik et al. “Mapping Agricultural Soil in Greenhouse Using an Autonomous Low-Cost Robot and Precise Monitoring”. In: *Sustainability* 14.23 (23 Jan. 2022), pp. 1–24. ISSN: 2071-1050. DOI: 10.3390/su142315539. URL: <https://www.mdpi.com/2071-1050/14/23/15539> (visited on 05/24/2025).
 - [57] Brooke Bruning et al. “The Development of Hyperspectral Distribution Maps to Predict the Content and Distribution of Nitrogen and Water in Wheat (*Triticum Aestivum*)”. In: *Frontiers in Plant Science* 10 (Oct. 30, 2019), pp. 1–2. ISSN: 1664-462X. DOI: 10.3389/fpls.2019.01380. URL: <https://www.frontiersin.org/journals/plant-science/articles/10.3389/fpls.2019.01380/full> (visited on 05/26/2025).
 - [58] Laura S. Peirone et al. “Assessing the Efficiency of Phenotyping Early Traits in a Greenhouse Automated Platform for Predicting Drought Tolerance of Soybean in the Field”. In: *Frontiers in Plant Science* 9 (May 3, 2018), pp. 1–2. ISSN: 1664-462X. DOI: 10.3389/fpls.2018.00587. URL: <https://www.frontiersin.org/journals/plant-science/articles/10.3389/fpls.2018.00587/full> (visited on 05/26/2025).
 - [59] Daoliang Li et al. “High-Throughput Plant Phenotyping Platform (HT3P) as a Novel Tool for Estimating Agronomic Traits From the Lab to the Field”. In: *Frontiers in Bioengineering and Biotechnology* 8 (Jan. 13, 2021), pp. 2–7. ISSN: 2296-4185. DOI: 10.3389/fbioe.2020.623705. URL: <https://www.frontiersin.org/articles/10.3389/fbioe.2020.623705/full> (visited on 05/24/2025).
 - [60] Carla Gomes. “Computational Sustainability Computational Methods for a Sustainable Environment, Economy, and Society”. In: *The BRIDGE* 39.4 (2009), pp. 5–13. URL: <https://computational-sustainability.cis.cornell.edu/pdfs/Gomes-NAE-Bridge-Winter09.pdf> (visited on 05/25/2025).
 - [61] Christian Bauckhage and Kristian Kersting. “Data Mining and Pattern Recognition in Agriculture”. In: *KI - Künstliche Intelligenz* 27.4 (Nov. 1, 2013), pp. 1–11. ISSN: 1610-1987. DOI: 10.1007/s13218-013-0273-0. URL: <https://doi.org/10.1007/s13218-013-0273-0> (visited on 05/25/2025).
 - [62] Olivier Debauche et al. “Cloud Architecture for Plant Phenotyping Research”. In: *Concurrency and Computation: Practice and Experience* 32.17 (Sept. 10, 2020), pp. 1–2. ISSN: 1532-0626, 1532-0634. DOI: 10.1002/cpe.5661. URL: <https://onlinelibrary.wiley.com/doi/10.1002/cpe.5661> (visited on 05/26/2025).
 - [63] M. Carvajal-Yepes et al. “A Global Surveillance System for Crop Diseases”. In: *Science* 364.6447 (June 28, 2019), pp. 1237–1239. ISSN: 0036-8075, 1095-9203. DOI: 10.1126/science.aaw1572. URL: <https://www.science.org/doi/10.1126/science.aaw1572> (visited on 05/21/2025).

- [64] Zhenbo Li et al. “A Review of Computer Vision Technologies for Plant Phenotyping”. In: *Computers and Electronics in Agriculture* 176 (Sept. 2020), p. 105672. ISSN: 01681699. DOI: [10.1016/j.compag.2020.105672](https://doi.org/10.1016/j.compag.2020.105672). URL: <https://linkinghub.elsevier.com/retrieve/pii/S0168169920307511> (visited on 06/01/2025).
- [65] Yu Jiang and Changying Li. “Convolutional Neural Networks for Image-Based High-Throughput Plant Phenotyping: A Review”. In: *Plant Phenomics* 2020 (Apr. 9, 2020). DOI: [10.34133/2020/4152816](https://doi.org/10.34133/2020/4152816). URL: <https://spj.science.org/doi/full/10.34133/2020/4152816> (visited on 05/25/2025).
- [66] Abbas Jafar et al. “Revolutionizing Agriculture with Artificial Intelligence: Plant Disease Detection Methods, Applications, and Their Limitations”. In: *Frontiers in Plant Science* 15 (Mar. 13, 2024). ISSN: 1664-462X. DOI: [10.3389/fpls.2024.1356260](https://doi.org/10.3389/fpls.2024.1356260). URL: <https://www.frontiersin.org/journals/plant-science/articles/10.3389/fpls.2024.1356260/full> (visited on 07/20/2025).
- [67] Geetharamani G. and Arun Pandian J. “Identification of Plant Leaf Diseases Using a Nine-Layer Deep Convolutional Neural Network”. In: *Computers & Electrical Engineering* 76 (June 1, 2019), pp. 323–338. ISSN: 0045-7906. DOI: [10.1016/j.compeleceng.2019.04.011](https://doi.org/10.1016/j.compeleceng.2019.04.011). URL: <https://www.sciencedirect.com/science/article/pii/S0045790619300023> (visited on 07/24/2025).
- [68] Mercelin Francis and C. Deisy. “Disease Detection and Classification in Agricultural Plants Using Convolutional Neural Networks — A Visual Understanding”. In: *2019 6th International Conference on Signal Processing and Integrated Networks (SPIN)*. 2019 6th International Conference on Signal Processing and Integrated Networks (SPIN). Mar. 2019, pp. 1063–1068. DOI: [10.1109/SPIN.2019.8711701](https://doi.org/10.1109/SPIN.2019.8711701). URL: <https://ieeexplore.ieee.org/abstract/document/8711701> (visited on 07/24/2025).
- [69] Meghana Govardhan and Veena M B. “Diagnosis of Tomato Plant Diseases Using Random Forest”. In: *2019 Global Conference for Advancement in Technology (GCAT)*. 2019 Global Conference for Advancement in Technology (GCAT). Oct. 2019, pp. 1–5. DOI: [10.1109/GCAT47503.2019.8978431](https://doi.org/10.1109/GCAT47503.2019.8978431). URL: <https://ieeexplore.ieee.org/document/8978431> (visited on 07/24/2025).
- [70] Sukhvir Kaur, Shreelekha Pandey, and Shivani Goel. “Plants Disease Identification and Classification Through Leaf Images: A Survey”. In: *Archives of Computational Methods in Engineering* 26.2 (Apr. 1, 2019), pp. 507–530. ISSN: 1886-1784. DOI: [10.1007/s11831-018-9255-6](https://doi.org/10.1007/s11831-018-9255-6). URL: <https://doi.org/10.1007/s11831-018-9255-6> (visited on 07/20/2025).
- [71] Fernando Perez-Sanz, Pedro J Navarro, and Marcos Egea-Cortines. “Plant Phenomics: An Overview of Image Acquisition Technologies and Image Data Analysis Algorithms”. In: *GigaScience* 6.11 (Nov. 1, 2017). ISSN: 2047-217X. DOI: [10.1093/gigascience/gix092](https://doi.org/10.1093/gigascience/gix092). URL: <https://academic.oup.com/gigascience/article/6/11/gix092/4611111> (visited on 07/20/2025).

oup.com/gigascience/article/doi/10.1093/gigascience/gix092/4316962 (visited on 05/21/2025).

- [72] H. Al Hiary et al. “Fast and Accurate Detection and Classification of Plant Diseases”. In: *International Journal of Computer Applications* 17.1 (Mar. 31, 2011), pp. 31–38. ISSN: 09758887. DOI: [10.5120/2183-2754](https://doi.org/10.5120/2183-2754). URL: <http://www.ijcaonline.org/volume17/number1/pxc3872754.pdf> (visited on 04/20/2025).
- [73] Smita Desai. “Enhancing Image Quality in Crop Disease Diagnosis: A Comparative Evaluation of Laplacian and Average Filtering with Established Techniques”. In: *Journal of Information Systems Engineering and Management* 10.5s (5s Jan. 24, 2025), pp. 662–670. ISSN: 2468-4376. DOI: [10.52783/jisem.v10i5s.757](https://doi.org/10.52783/jisem.v10i5s.757). URL: <https://www.jisem-journal.com/index.php/journal/article/view/757> (visited on 07/27/2025).
- [74] Rafael C. Gonzalez and Richard E. Woods. *Digital Image Processing*. Fourth edition, global edition. New York: Pearson, 2017. 1 p. ISBN: 978-0-13-335672-4 978-1-292-22307-0 978-1-292-22304-9.
- [75] Varkala Tarun Sai et al. “Image Quality Enhancement for Wheat Rust Diseased Leaf Image Using Histogram Equalization & CLAHE”. In: *E3S Web of Conferences* 391 (2023). Ed. by S.K. Tummala et al., p. 01029. ISSN: 2267-1242. DOI: [10.1051/e3sconf/202339101029](https://doi.org/10.1051/e3sconf/202339101029). URL: <https://www.e3s-conferences.org/10.1051/e3sconf/202339101029> (visited on 07/26/2025).
- [76] K. Thangadurai and K. Padmavathi. “Computer Visionimage Enhancement for Plant Leaves Disease Detection”. In: *2014 World Congress on Computing and Communication Technologies*. 2014 World Congress on Computing and Communication Technologies. Feb. 2014, pp. 173–175. DOI: [10.1109/WCCCT.2014.39](https://doi.org/10.1109/WCCCT.2014.39). URL: <https://ieeexplore.ieee.org/abstract/document/6755131> (visited on 07/26/2025).
- [77] Keumsun Park, Minah Chae, and Jae Hyuk Cho. “Image Pre-Processing Method of Machine Learning for Edge Detection with Image Signal Processor Enhancement”. In: *Micromachines* 12.1 (Jan. 11, 2021), p. 73. ISSN: 2072-666X. DOI: [10.3390/mi12010073](https://doi.org/10.3390/mi12010073). URL: <https://www.mdpi.com/2072-666X/12/1/73> (visited on 07/27/2025).
- [78] Robert M. Haralick, K. Shanmugam, and Its’Hak Dinstein. “Textural Features for Image Classification”. In: *IEEE Transactions on Systems, Man, and Cybernetics* SMC-3.6 (Nov. 1973), pp. 610–621. ISSN: 0018-9472, 2168-2909. DOI: [10.1109/TSMC.1973.4309314](https://doi.org/10.1109/TSMC.1973.4309314). URL: <http://ieeexplore.ieee.org/document/4309314/> (visited on 07/27/2025).
- [79] Nobuyuki Otsu. “A Threshold Selection Method from Gray-Level Histograms”. In: *IEEE Transactions on Systems, Man, and Cybernetics* 9.1 (Jan. 1979), pp. 62–66. ISSN: 2168-2909. DOI: [10.1109/TSMC.1979.4310076](https://doi.org/10.1109/TSMC.1979.4310076). URL: <https://ieeexplore.ieee.org/document/4310076/> (visited on 07/28/2025).

- [80] Jadwiga Rogowska. “Chapter 5 - Overview and Fundamentals of Medical Image Segmentation”. In: *Handbook of Medical Image Processing and Analysis (Second Edition)*. Ed. by ISAAC N. Bankman. Burlington: Academic Press, Jan. 1, 2009, pp. 73–90. ISBN: 978-0-12-373904-9. DOI: [10.1016/B978-012373904-9.50013-1](https://doi.org/10.1016/B978-012373904-9.50013-1). URL: <https://www.sciencedirect.com/science/article/pii/B9780123739049500131> (visited on 07/28/2025).
- [81] Sandra Jardim, João António, and Carlos Mora. “Image Thresholding Approaches for Medical Image Segmentation - Short Literature Review”. In: *Procedia Computer Science* 219 (2023), pp. 1485–1492. ISSN: 18770509. DOI: [10.1016/j.procs.2023.01.439](https://doi.org/10.1016/j.procs.2023.01.439). URL: <https://linkinghub.elsevier.com/retrieve/pii/S1877050923004489> (visited on 07/27/2025).
- [82] Ashok Samal and Sruti Das Choudhury, eds. *Intelligent Image Analysis for Plant Phenotyping*. First edition. Boca Raton, FL: CRC Press, 2021. ISBN: 978-1-138-03855-4.
- [83] Asma Najjar and Ezzeddine Zagrouba. “Flower Image Segmentation Based on Color Analysis and a Supervised Evaluation”. In: *2012 International Conference on Communications and Information Technology (ICCIT)*. 2012 International Conference on Communications and Information Technology (ICCIT). June 2012, pp. 397–401. DOI: [10.1109/ICCITechnol.2012.6285834](https://doi.org/10.1109/ICCITechnol.2012.6285834). URL: <https://ieeexplore.ieee.org/document/6285834> (visited on 07/28/2025).
- [84] Dae Gwan Kim et al. “Classification of Grapefruit Peel Diseases Using Color Texture Feature Analysis”. In: ().
- [85] S. Arivazhagan et al. “Detection of Unhealthy Region of Plant Leaves and Classification of Plant Leaf Diseases Using Texture Features”. In: *Agricultural Engineering International: CIGR Journal* 15.1 (1 Apr. 9, 2013), pp. 211–217. ISSN: 1682-1130. URL: <https://cigrjournal.org/index.php/Ejournal/article/view/2338> (visited on 07/26/2025).
- [86] Usama Mokhtar et al. “SVM-Based Detection of Tomato Leaves Diseases”. In: *Intelligent Systems’2014*. Ed. by D. Filev et al. Cham: Springer International Publishing, 2015, pp. 641–652. ISBN: 978-3-319-11310-4. DOI: [10.1007/978-3-319-11310-4_55](https://doi.org/10.1007/978-3-319-11310-4_55).
- [87] Nisar Ahmed, Hafiz Muhammad Shahzad Asif, and Gulshan Saleem. *Leaf Image-based Plant Disease Identification Using Color and Texture Features*. Feb. 8, 2021. DOI: [10.48550/arXiv.2102.04515](https://doi.org/10.48550/arXiv.2102.04515). arXiv: [2102.04515 \[cs\]](https://arxiv.org/abs/2102.04515). URL: <http://arxiv.org/abs/2102.04515> (visited on 07/18/2025). Pre-published.
- [88] F. Argenti, L. Alparone, and G. Benelli. “Fast Algorithms for Texture Analysis Using Co-Occurrence Matrices”. In: *IEEE Proceedings F: Radar and Signal Processing* 137.6 (1990), p. 443. ISSN: 0956375X. DOI: [10.1049/ip-f-2.1990.0064](https://doi.org/10.1049/ip-f-2.1990.0064). URL: <https://digital-library.theiet.org/content/journals/10.1049/ip-f-2.1990.0064> (visited on 07/28/2025).

- [89] Sunil S. Harakannanavar et al. “Plant Leaf Disease Detection Using Computer Vision and Machine Learning Algorithms”. In: *Global Transitions Proceedings* 3.1 (June 2022), pp. 305–310. ISSN: 2666285X. DOI: [10.1016/j.gltp.2022.03.016](https://doi.org/10.1016/j.gltp.2022.03.016). URL: <https://linkinghub.elsevier.com/retrieve/pii/S2666285X22000218> (visited on 07/27/2025).
- [90] D Boolchandani and Vineet Sahula. “Exploring Efficient Kernel Functions for Support Vector Machine Based Feasibility Models for Analog Circuits”. In: ().
- [91] *Advanced Data Mining Techniques*. Berlin, Heidelberg: Springer Berlin Heidelberg, 2008. ISBN: 978-3-540-76916-3 978-3-540-76917-0. DOI: [10.1007/978-3-540-76917-0](https://doi.org/10.1007/978-3-540-76917-0). URL: <http://link.springer.com/10.1007/978-3-540-76917-0> (visited on 07/22/2025).
- [92] Fernando López-García et al. “Automatic Detection of Skin Defects in Citrus Fruits Using a Multivariate Image Analysis Approach”. In: *Computers and Electronics in Agriculture* 71.2 (May 1, 2010), pp. 189–197. ISSN: 0168-1699. DOI: [10.1016/j.compag.2010.02.001](https://doi.org/10.1016/j.compag.2010.02.001). URL: <https://www.sciencedirect.com/science/article/pii/S016816991000013X> (visited on 07/22/2025).